

Celtic Metal

The Celtic clans were superb metalworkers, fashioning goods from bronze, iron, and gold. Ornate items have been discovered at sites in Central and Western Europe, and are distinctively decorated, often with images of animals and plants.

[1] **The Battersea shield**, which was found in the Thames River, London. Dating from the 2nd century BCE, this was probably for display rather than battle, as it is made of thin bronze and intricately decorated. [2] **Bronze dog figurine**, which probably had some mythological or religious significance. [3] **Hallstatt bull sculpture** found on a site in Moravia, Czech Republic, and dating from c. 450 BCE. [4] **Harness decoration**, which was discovered in a grave in northern France. [5] **Bronze Hallstatt ornamental hatchet**, found in Austria. Dating from c. 650 BCE, it features the figure of a rider. [6] **Horned helmet**, possibly for ceremonial use, and dating to c. 250–50 BCE. It is the only helmet of its type to have been found in Europe. [7] **Carved metal spoon**, dating from the 6th century CE and discovered in Kilkenny, Ireland. [8] **Part of a harness** found in Cambridge, England and worked in bronze, with an engraved central design. [9] **Base of the Gundestrup Cauldron** (see pp.134–35), showing the ritual slaying of a bull. [10] **Enamel ornament**,

which would have decorated the chariot of a high-ranking horseman. It was found in Norfolk, England. [11] **The Stanwick Horse Mask**, a chariot fixture dating to the 1st century CE and discovered in Yorkshire, England. [12] **Bronze brooch** from c. 1000 BCE, and discovered in Austria. [13] **Ceremonial dagger** of iron and bronze, which was found in Britain. [14] **Enameled chariot hardware** found in Wales and dating from the 1st century CE. [15] **Chariot ornament** from 2nd century BCE. [16] **Bronze javelin heads**. [17] **The decorated bronze surface** of the back of a mirror, featuring a symmetrical clover leaf pattern, possibly belonging to a high-ranking woman. [18] **Bronze ornament** of the 1st century CE discovered in Ireland; its function remains unknown. [19] **Gold coins** dating from c. 1st century CE, and probably originating from northern France. [20] **Decorated bronze harness** discovered in an Irish peat bog. [21] **Silver pin brooch** decorated with animals. [22] **Bridle bit** worked in bronze and dating to the 2nd or 3rd century BCE.



[19] GOLD COINS



[20] BRONZE HARNESS



[21] BROOCH



[22] BRIDLE BIT



[13] CEREMONIAL DAGGER



[14] CHARIOT HARDWARE



[15] CHARIOT DECORATION



[16] JAVELIN HEADS



[17] MIRROR



[18] BRONZE ORNAMENT

